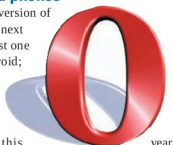




Opera mobile OS on Android-based phones

Opera has announced plans to release a beta version of Opera Mobile for Android phones within the next month. The company has so far confirmed just one of the new features in Opera Mobile for Android; and it's going to be the long-awaited pinch-to-zoom support. Opera already offers Opera Mini on the iPhone—a scaled-down version of its browser, which the company says will receive an updated version this year featuring both pinch-to-zoom and hardware acceleration. “Opera Mobile for Android is the real McCoy. It's the full Web browser on the phone,” Christen Krogh, chief development officer of Opera said at a press conference. “The current versions of Opera Mobile and Opera Mini have two levels of zoom. One for the full page width and one for zooming in to read the text. With the introduction of pinch-to-zoom, you are in full control of the zoom level. Text redraws almost instantly at all zoom levels, so text will always look sharp and easy to read. All this without compromising the speed or data compression in Opera Mini and Opera Mobile,” explains Opera's Aleksander Aas in a blog post.



Google Goggles for iPhone now available

Almost a year after it hit Android, Google Goggles, a downloadable image recognition application used for searches based on pictures taken by handheld devices, is finally here for the iPhone as well. It was primarily developed for use on Google's Android operating systems for mobile devices. The new version of Google Mobile App allows you to just tap on the camera button to search using Goggles. Goggles will analyse the image and highlight the objects it recognises. Google makes it clear that it works well for landmarks, logos, book covers, DVDs and games, but doesn't yet work for some things that you might want to try, like animals, plants or food.



Acer's new range of netbooks offer dual boot

Acer has come up with its new dual-core Aspire One netbooks that let users run both Windows 7 and Google's Android OSs. Hitting the market with the Aspire One D250 and D260, the company allows users to switch over to Windows 7 in case they really don't like to work on Android. These netbooks also feature Intel's Atom 550 processor, according to a report in DigiTimes. The company also plans to continue this strategy and use the dual-boot feature on all upcoming dual-core netbooks.



MeeGo devices won't appear till 2011

According to the vice president of Intel's software and solutions group, Doug Fisher, MeeGo devices are behind schedule, and it will not be until early 2011 that consumers would be able to see smartphones running the OS. Nokia, on the other hand, has been largely tight-lipped about a MeeGo-based Nokia N9 smartphone. MeeGo, a Linux-based open source mobile operating system project, combines Nokia's Maemo (featured on Nokia N900) and Intel's Moblin OS. The delay could be attributed to the recent troubles Nokia is facing with the departure of the VP of MeeGo devices, Ari Jaaksi. On the positive side however, Intel has confirmed that by the end of the year, consumers can look forward to netbooks and even Internet-connected TVs running the OS.

Next version of Android to be called 'Ice-Cream'

After having released the 2.2 update, codenamed FroYo (Frozen Yoghurt) in May this year, Google is readying one of its next versions of Android 4.0, which would in all probability be called Ice-Cream.

Google has had a legacy of naming the Android releases after desserts in alphabetical order. It started with Cupcake (Android 1.5), Doughnut (1.6), Eclair (2.0) and the latest FroYo (2.2). The company has already confirmed the names of subsequent versions -- Gingerbread (3.0) and Honeycomb (3.5) but has kept mum on further releases. A few people have been speculating about what the name beginning with an I could be. However, recently, the president of ARM, one of the world's largest manufacturers of chips for smartphones, tablets and other mobile devices, Tudor Brown, confirmed that the next version would indeed be called Ice-Cream.